

A LOCAL'S GUIDE · GIFTED BY YOUR HOST

Cape Town, Sorted

The Mother City made easy - where to go, when to go, and how to skip the queues. Yours to keep.



Compiled with care by AssetProof

Welcome to the Mother City

Cape Town rewards travellers who read the day right. In summer the "**Cape Doctor**" - a brisk south-easter - can sweep in and reshape your plans; it clears the air but makes exposed beaches and high hikes hard work. When you see cloud pouring over the top of **Table Mountain** like a "**tablecloth**", that's the south-easter at play: the cableway often closes, so pivot to a sheltered plan.

The golden rule: **chase the calm, beat the heat, dodge the queues**. Mornings are usually stillest and coolest; light winds and clear skies are your green light for the mountain, the Cape and the open beaches. This little guide is yours to keep - gifted by your host, compiled with care by your hosting team.

Why is AssetProof on your guide?



We're the quiet team behind a great stay. Before you arrived, we documented this home end to end - a short visual tour let us inventory the contents, assess the condition, flag anything to put right, and build the checklists that keep it guest-perfect - and we give the owner the reports that keep their finger on the pulse, all for your comfort. We know this home, and we know this city - so we put both to work to hand you these tour ideas, local tips and time-savers. This guide is just a taste of what we do. Enjoy Cape Town - you're in good hands.

The Cape Town Matrix

20 things to do - colour-coded by interest, tagged for weather, season, effort and time, with the best-time / pre-book trick. A gold ★ marks the unmissable.

Weather

Sunny

Rain-
friendlyWind-
OK

Unmissable

Interest

Nature

Culture

Food & Wine

Beach

Family

Romance

★ **Table Mountain Cableway**

Nature



Year-round Effort: Low 2-3 hrs

PRE-BOOK online. First car (08:00) or last light. Closes in high wind.

★ **Lion's Head sunrise/sunset hike**

Nature



Year-round Effort: Med-High 2-3 hrs

Go for sunrise or full-moon nights. Skip in strong wind/rain.

★ **Cape Point & Cape of Good Hope**

Nature



Year-round Effort: Med Half day

Pre-book park entry online. Early start beats coach tours.

★ **Boulders Beach penguins**

Family



Year-round Effort: Low 1-2 hrs

Open from 08:00 - arrive first. Boardwalk works even when breezy.

V&A Waterfront

Family



Year-round Effort: Low 2-4 hrs

Check if a cruise ship is in (busiest). Weekday mornings calmer.

★ **Robben Island ferry & tour**

Culture



Year-round Effort: Low Half day

PRE-BOOK well ahead. Ferries cancel in big swell/wind - go calm days.

★ **Kirstenbosch Botanical Garden**

Nature



Spr-Sum Effort: Low 2-3 hrs

Spring blooms (Sep-Oct). Tree Canopy 'Boomslang' walkway is a must.

★ **Constantia wine route**

Food & Wine



Year-round Effort: Low Half day

Nearest vineyards to the city. Book a tasting; use Uber, don't drive.

Bo-Kaap walk & Cape Malay food

Culture



Year-round Effort: Low 1-2 hrs

Respect homes when photographing. Pair with a cooking class indoors.

★ Chapman's Peak Drive

Romance



Year-round Effort: Low 1-2 hrs

Toll road; may close in rockfall/wind. Sunset drive is unbeatable.

Camps Bay beach & strip

Beach



Summer Effort: Low 2-4 hrs

First-light or late afternoon beats the midday crowd & heat.

Muizenberg surf & beach huts

Family



Year-round Effort: Low 2-3 hrs

Warmer False Bay water. Great beginner surf; lessons bookable.

Two Oceans Aquarium

Family



Year-round Effort: Low 2-3 hrs

Top rainy-day pick at the V&A. Pre-book to skip the queue.

Zeitz MOCAA art museum

Culture



Year-round Effort: Low 2 hrs

Stunning silo architecture. Ideal windy/rainy plan-B.

Company's Garden & museums

Culture



Year-round Effort: Low 2-3 hrs

City-centre green lung; cluster of museums for wet days.

Hout Bay & Seal Island cruise

Family

☀️ Year-round Effort: Low 1-2 hrs

Short harbour cruise; can be choppy in wind. Morning calmer.

★ Stellenbosch / Franschhoek wine day

Food & Wine

☀️ Year-round Effort: Low Full day

Use the wine tram or a driver. Book lunch + tastings ahead.

★ Signal Hill sundowners

Romance

☀️ Year-round Effort: Low 1 hr

Drive up for sunset. Noon Gun fires Mon-Sat at 12:00.

Sea Point Promenade stroll

Family

☀️ 🚶 Year-round Effort: Low 1 hr

Flat, easy, ocean-side. Good even on breezy days; cafes en route.

★ Whale watching, Hermanus

Nature

☀️ Win-Spr Effort: Low Full day

Jun-Nov is peak Southern Right season. Land-based viewing is free.

After dark, active & shopping

Bars & nightlife

- **Sundowners:** the Camps Bay & Sea Point strips for sea-facing cocktails.
- **Late nights:** Bree & Kloof Streets (City Bowl) for bars and live music; rooftop bars around the CBD & Waterfront.
- [What's on tonight →](#)

Fitness & wellness

- Run or cycle the **Sea Point Promenade**; sunrise Lion's Head; Kirstenbosch trails.
- Yoga, pilates, padel & gyms across the City Bowl & Atlantic Seaboard; spas at the Waterfront & in Constantia.
- [Find a class or spa →](#)

Shopping & markets

- **Malls:** V&A Waterfront & Canal Walk. **Design & boutiques:** Bree St, the CBD & Woodstock.
- **Markets (mostly weekends):** Oranjezicht Farm, Neighbourgoods (Woodstock), Bay Harbour (Hout Bay).
- **Markets open today →**

Whatever the weather



Rainy-day winners

- Two Oceans Aquarium & Zeitz MOCAA at the V&A
- Company's Garden museums & the Castle of Good Hope
- A Cape Malay cooking class in the Bo-Kaap
- Constantia cellar tastings (indoors, fireside in winter)



Windy plan-B

- Swap the high mountain for sheltered **False Bay** (Muizenberg, Boulders)
- Head inland to the **Winelands** - valleys are calmer
- Sea Point Promenade & harbour cafes stay enjoyable
- Save Cape Point & Robben Island for a calmer day



Read the tablecloth

Cloud cascading over Table Mountain = strong south-easter. The cableway and Lion's Head get rough and may close. If the "tablecloth" is out, go low and sheltered today and save the summit for a clear, still morning.

Beat the crowds, queues & peak prices

Dec – mid Jan

PEAK

Festive season & local school holidays. Busiest and priciest - book everything well ahead.

Feb – Apr

SWEET SPOT

Warm, calmer wind, thinner crowds, better value. The connoisseur's window.

May – Aug

QUIET

Winter: cooler, wetter, greenest, cheapest. Whales arrive; cosy cellar season.

Sep – Nov

SWEET SPOT

Spring flowers, whales offshore, rising sun, shoulder pricing.

How to dodge the crush

- **Table Mountain:** pre-book the cableway online and take the first car (08:00) or the last light slot - midday queues are longest.
- **Go weekday, go early or late:** attractions are calmest at opening and in the late afternoon.
- **V&A Waterfront:** check whether a cruise ship is in port before you go - that's the difference between a stroll and a scrum.
- **Beat the traffic:** avoid the N1/N2 at rush hour (approx 07:00-09:00 & 16:00-18:00).
- **Beaches:** first-light or sunset beats midday for light, space and parking.
- **Eat early or late:** book the 18:00 or the 21:00 table to skip the peak-hour wait.
- **Cape Point & Robben Island:** pre-book entry/ferries; sail on calm days as wind cancels crossings.

Ready-made days

The Classic City Day

Best for: Sun, low wind

08:00 - First cableway car up Table Mountain

10:30 - Bo-Kaap walk + Cape Malay bite

13:00 - Lunch & stroll at the V&A Waterfront

16:00 - Sundowners on Signal Hill

The Cape Peninsula Loop

Best for: Sun, calm

08:00 - Chapman's Peak Drive (top down)

10:00 - Boulders Beach penguins

12:00 - Cape Point & Cape of Good Hope

16:00 - Seafood late lunch in Hout Bay

Wine & Mountains

Best for: Any (great in light rain)

09:30 - Constantia tasting (or the wine tram in Stellenbosch)

12:30 - Long vineyard lunch

15:00 - Kirstenbosch garden & Boomslang walkway

17:30 - Easy Sea Point Promenade stroll

Rainy-Day Culture

Best for: Rain or strong wind

09:30 - Two Oceans Aquarium

11:30 - Zeitz MOCAA contemporary art

13:30 - Company's Garden museums

16:00 - Cooking class or cellar tasting

Slow & Romantic

Best for: Calm evening

16:00 - Camps Bay late-afternoon beach

18:00 - Chapman's Peak sunset drive

19:30 - Quiet dinner (book early or late)

21:30 - Stargaze from Signal Hill

Guest essentials

Getting around

- **Uber & Bolt** are cheap, plentiful and the easiest way around.
- **MyCiTi** buses cover the city, Waterfront, Camps Bay & the airport.
- Driving is on the **left**; distances are bigger than they look.

Money & tipping

- Tip **~10-15%** in restaurants; a little for car guards & porters.
- Cards are widely accepted; carry some cash for markets.
- Housekeeper: a kind touch is **~R50-R100 per bedroom, per night**, left at the end of your stay.

Stay safe & well

- Keep valuables out of sight; use ride apps after dark.
- The African sun is fierce - **sunscreen, hat, water**, even when breezy.
- Tap water is safe to drink across the city.

Practical bits

- **Emergencies:** 112 from any mobile, or 10111 (police).
- **SIM/data:** grab a local prepaid SIM at the airport or a mall.
- **Plugs:** Type M / N, 230V - bring an adapter.

Good to know

In an emergency

- **112** - from any mobile (all emergencies)
- **10111** police • **10177** ambulance
- **NSRI** sea rescue & mountain trouble: dial **112** or ask the concierge
- Save your host's number and this address the moment you arrive.

Speak a little local

- **Howzit** - hi / how's it going
- **Lekker** - great, tasty, fun • **Braai** - barbecue
- **Dankie** (Afrikaans) / **Enkosi** (Xhosa) - thank you
- **Robot** - traffic light • **Now-now** - shortly-ish

Give with care

If you'd like to help, give through a reputable local charity or your host's suggested platform rather than on the street - it does more lasting good and keeps everyone safe. Ask the concierge for a vetted option.

Arrivals & luggage

- Arriving before check-in or leaving after check-out? Ask about **luggage storage** so you don't lose a day.
- Uber/Bolt from the airport is easy and cheap - agree the pick-up spot before you set off.

Hidden gems

- **Sunrise at Lion's Head** - beat the crowds and the heat for a 360-degree glow.
- **Oranjezicht City Farm Market** (weekends) - local produce by the sea.
- **Llandudno sundown** - a quieter, dramatic alternative to Camps Bay.
- **Scarborough & Misty Cliffs** - wild, uncrowded coastline past Kommetjie.
- **The Foreshore & CBD street art** - a self-guided wander between cafes.

- Newlands Forest walk - shady, sheltered greenery when the wind blows.

Need something arranged? Just ask.



Your concierge can line up the extras that make a trip effortless - airport transfers, a hire car, a private chef or in-home dinner, guided tours and wine days, a spa treatment, babysitting, or a fridge stocked before you land. Tell it what you need and it'll sort a trusted local option.

Here now and stuck? Ask your Cape Town concierge.

Tell it today's weather, your tastes and your energy, and get a plan made just for you. Want it to remember you and keep your guide handy? Add your WhatsApp and it'll tailor everything - and send your guide to keep.

Open your Cape Town concierge →

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